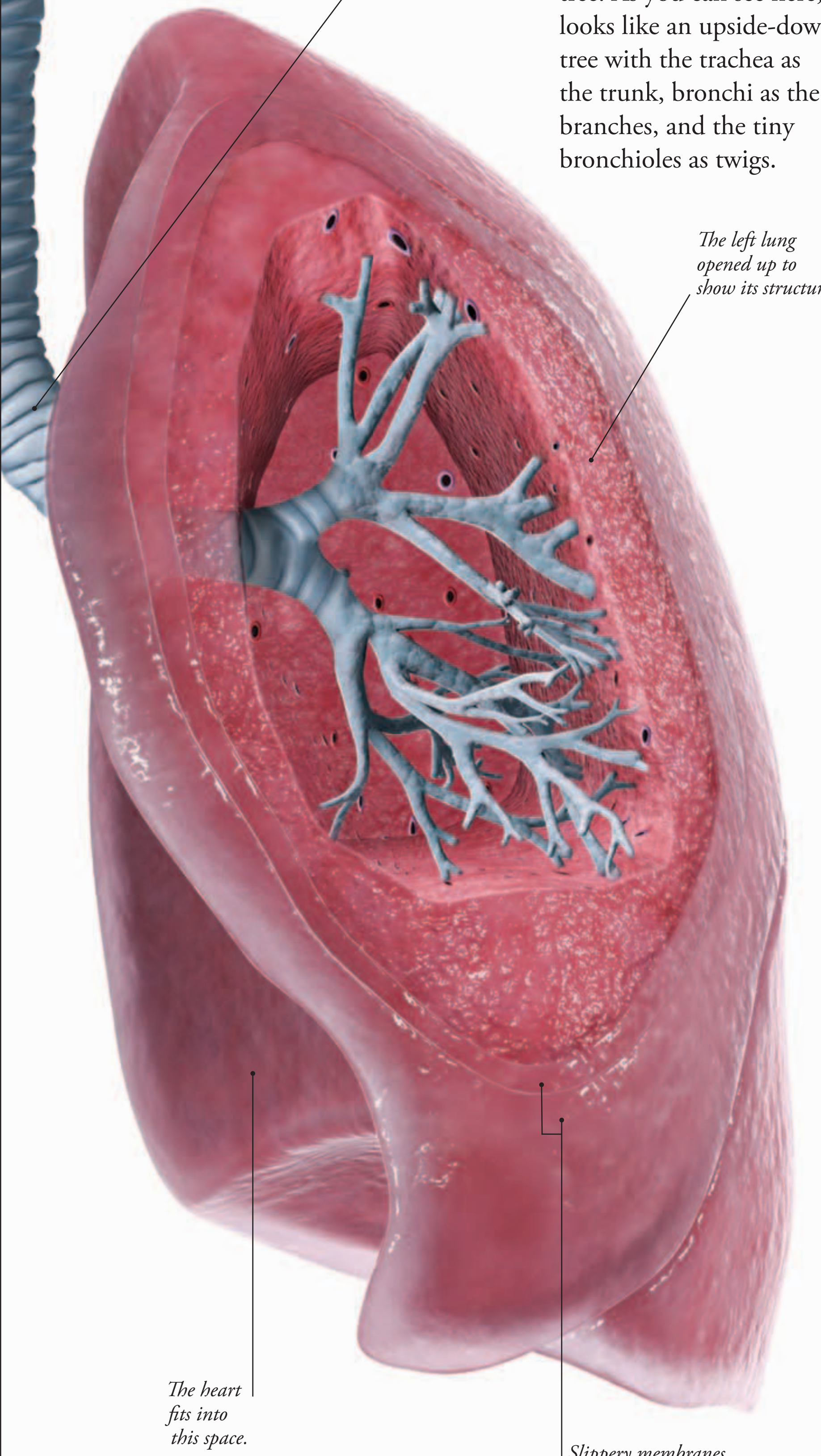
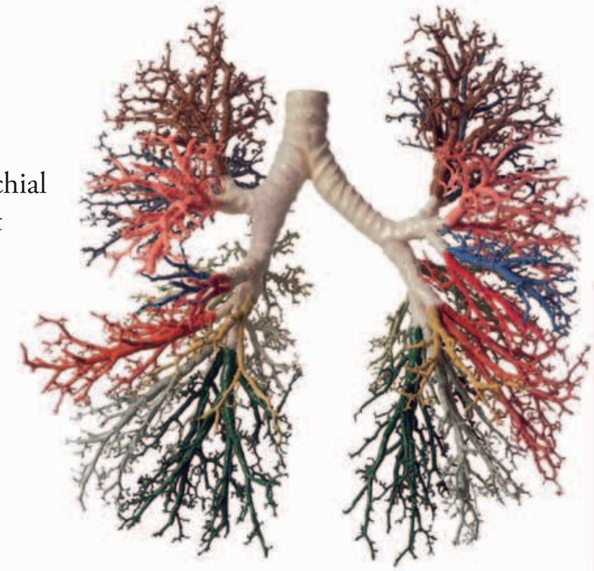


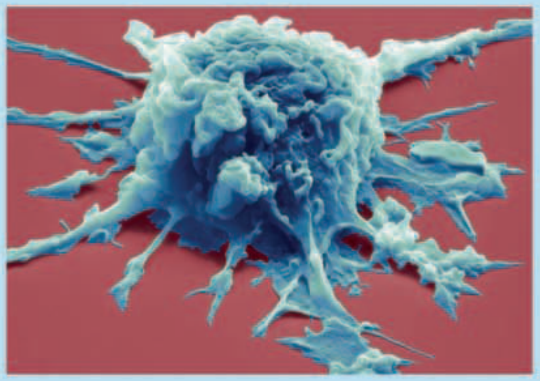
BRONCHIAL TREE

The branching network of airways inside the lungs is sometimes called the bronchial tree. As you can see here, it looks like an upside-down tree with the trachea as the trunk, bronchi as the branches, and the tiny bronchioles as twigs.



LOOK CLOSER: DUST GOBBLERS

When you breathe in air, most dust particles, pollen grains, and germs are trapped by sticky mucus in the nose and airways. But some of them travel deep into the lungs. Before they can do any harm, they are gobbled up by wandering macrophages.



▲ GERM EATER *A macrophage is a type of white blood cell. It moves by extending its narrow "arms," which it also uses to grab foreign particles.*

INTO THE BLOOD

This is a close-up view of what happens at the junction between an alveolus and a capillary. Oxygen travels from the alveolus into the blood, and carbon dioxide moves in the opposite direction.